

The Lost Sandals

A boy named Joel, wanted a new pair of sandals. He didn't have money, so he had an idea. He planned to beg by the entrance of the market far away from his home where people did not know him. People passed him by, some even kicked him and he barely got anything so he started thinking of other ways to get money.

Suddenly, he thought of a bold plan- stealing. Since Joel was born and raised in a Christian household, with a faithful Christian father, he knew stealing was a sin. He felt anxious about this thought. Unfortunately, he still went with his idea, thinking there was no other way. Joel knew God would be disappointed in his choice but he acted like he didn't care.

Joel felt so guilty that he could not sleep. He tossed and turned in bed. He knew the guilt was ruining his sleep. Eventually, he went off into a restless slumber. When he got up in the morning, he rushed to get ready and get out of the house. His father noticed the change in his behavior and asked him "Joel, why are you rushing yourself so early in the morning?" He told his father he was late to go meet a friend so his father did not think much of it anymore and let him go.

Having lied to his father, Joel secretly snuck back to his house, went up to his father's bedroom and looked for his wallet. He found the wallet, and took the money for those new pair of sandals

he wanted. He rushed to the market in search of the “Shoe Shop” which sold the sandals. He found the shop and entered.

He came upon the clerk and told the man that he wanted to buy a pair of sandals. To his dismay, the clerk informed him, “Before I could let you purchase the pair of sandals, I need you to get a Parents, Adults, or Guardians. ID for this purchase”. This brought a new wave of anxiety to Joel about what could happen.

In that moment, he found himself confessing to a stranger and he said, “I stole from my father and I feel truly guilty”. The clerk, who was suddenly hit with a wave of pity, sat Joel down and asked him if Joel would like him to call his father. Joel just nodded and gave the man his father’s number. “Father”, said Joel, “I have something to tell you”

So, Joel told his father about how he stole from him and the shame that he felt over his actions. When Joel was done, his father responded, “Joel I am very disappointed in you but I am also proud of you.” A confused Joel asked his father, “Why are you proud of me? You should only be disappointed.” His father explained that although Joel did something wrong, he owned up to his wrongdoing and he told the truth. With that, his father told him to come home and ended their phone call. They would have to talk more about it when he got home.

On his way home, Joel came across a little girl who was having trouble crossing the road. Joel forgot about his recent troubles and jumped into action to get the girl across the road. Joel got her safely across the road and he took it upon himself to get her home as it was getting dark.

The little girl's parents were so happy to see their child home and safe that they decided to reward Joel for his kindness. They gave him a box, insisting he take it as a token of their gratitude. As Joel was already late to get to his own home, he thanked the parents for a gift he did not think he deserved. Getting the girl home was the right and only thing to do. It felt like his responsibility. He made his way home curious about what was in the box but he was in a rush to make it to his father for their dreaded conversation that he had no time to open the box.

Joel's father was waiting for him at home with dinner ready. Joel could tell he was still disappointed but he returned his money and sat down at the table to eat after he had washed up. His father reassured him that he had forgiven him but Joel would have to earn back the trust he lost. Joel was very thankful to his father for his understanding and to God for giving him the will to be honest even when it was hard.

Suddenly Joel remembered the box and he told his father the story of the little girl he met on his way home and how he ended up with the box. His father, now very proud of his son for being so considerate, encouraged him to open the box after dinner. They cleaned up their dishes, and Joel got the box from his room to open with his father.

Upon opening the box, Joel almost cried. He saw the very sandals he had wanted lying there in the box. He tried it on and it was just the right size for him- like the little girl's parents knew what he had wanted all along. His father took this moment to remind him that all things happen in God's time. Just like the sandals. He reminded Joel that God has a way of reminding us that he is in control.

You may have to wait sometimes but once you give your worries, hopes, dreams, wants and needs to God, He will find a way if it is meant to be yours. Your responsibility is do your good deeds and trust in His word.

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